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The Hindu Editorial Vocabulary

Vocabulary:

1. **Turmoil (अशांति)** – A state of great disturbance, confusion, or uncertainty.
2. **Keenness (उत्सुकता)** – The quality of being eager, enthusiastic, or highly interested.
3. **Prerequisite (पूर्वापेक्षा)** – A necessary condition that must be met before something else can happen.
4. **Sapped (धीरे-धीरे कमजोर होना)** – Gradually weaken or destroy strength or power.
5. **Overhauling (पुनर्निर्माण/सुधार)** – The process of improving or repairing something.
6. **Veil (नकाब/आड़)** – Something that conceals or disguises.
7. **Contemporaneous (समकालिक)** – Existing or occurring in the same period of time.
8. **Culminating (चरम पर पहुँचना)** – To reach a climax or highest development.
9. **Dissipation (नष्ट होना/अपव्यय)** – The process of slowly disappearing or wasting away.
10. **Lacuna (फासला/रिक्त स्थान)** – An unfilled space or gap.

PHRASAL VERBS:

1. Wind down
Meaning – To relax or gradually bring something to an end.

2. Get across
Meaning – To successfully communicate or convey a message.

3. Carve out
Meaning – To create or obtain something, often with effort.

4. Rope in
Meaning – To persuade or involve someone in a task or activity.

Idioms & Phrases

1. The early bird catches the worm
Meaning: The person who takes the earliest action gets the best results

2. Kill two birds with one stone
Meaning: To accomplish two tasks with a single effort

3. Hold out an olive branch
Meaning: To offer peace or attempt to end a dispute

4. Catch someone red-handed
Meaning: To catch someone in the act of doing something wrong or illegal.

5. Roll out the red carpet

Meaning: To give special treatment or a warm welcome, especially to important guests.

Articles (Reading & Skimming)

Article for Reading:

Learning steps: On the Union Budget and education

Besides some high-profile announcements, such as an AI Centre of Excellence for education with an allocation of ₹500 crore, broadband connectivity for schools, the expansion of five third-generation IITs, and increased funding for Indian knowledge systems, Budget 2025 has promised higher allocations for education compared to last year's revised estimates. There was a 7% increase for higher education, although the actual expenditure for 2023-24 was 10% more than the 2025-26 Budget estimates. A key challenge in higher education is that the ambitious UGC reforms, modelled on advanced nations, require significant funding. For instance, introducing four-year degree programmes, allowing students to take courses across multiple institutions, implementing bi-annual admissions, and other structural changes demand substantial finances, which will inevitably fall upon State governments. However, Budget 2025 does not appear to adequately address these financial concerns. The release of the ASER 2024 report in the same week as the Union Budget highlighted gaps in India's school education system, particularly in foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN). While the report indicated that learning losses from the COVID-19 pandemic have been recovered, and, in some cases, FLN levels are at their highest ever, India still has some way to go before achieving full FLN, the 2026-27 target under the NIPUN Bharat scheme. Compared to the 2024-25 revised estimates (RE), school education has been allocated an additional ₹11,000 crore, a 16% increase. However, as a percentage of the total Budget, this increase is only 0.12 percentage points, bringing the allocation to 1.55%. In higher education, the Budget fraction remains unchanged at 0.99%. While institutions such as Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan continue to receive significant funding, the increase does reflect higher inflows to States, which are the primary implementers of school education programmes. The Centre has been keen on fully

implementing the National Education Policy (NEP), which proposes a 5+3+3+4 system that includes five years of early education up to Class 3. Early education is being prioritised as the key to achieving full FLN, but a critical gap remains: the two years before Class 1 are managed by underpaid anganwadi workers, who are already overburdened and often lack adequate training to deliver on FLN goals. A focused FLN drive is pivotal to achieving full FLN, a prerequisite for building a highly skilled workforce and leveraging India's demographic dividend. Over the next few years, depending on the progress made, the government must further strengthen school education investments to ensure India meets its full FLN target. Time is of the essence.

Article for Skimming:

The U.S.'s exit from WHO, a chance to reshape global health

On January 20, 2025, the United States government issued an executive order to withdraw from membership of the World Health Organization (WHO). This has raised apprehensions that reduced funding for WHO would impact the functionality of the organisation. However, as the executive decision by the U.S. government has already been made, it is time to reflect on some fundamental questions such as why a single country's exit from WHO is causing so much concern. How can the U.S.'s exit from WHO be converted into an opportunity to create a stronger WHO? Why is there a need for an increasingly greater role of countries in Asia and Africa in global health. To understand the impact of the U.S.'s withdrawal on WHO funding, we need to understand WHO's funding system. There are two broad categories of funding sources. In the first, the assessed contribution (or AC) is a fixed amount each WHO member-state must pay annually as a sort of membership fee. This is what the U.S. President has argued as being disproportionately high (for the U.S.) and cited as one of the reasons for the U.S.'s decision regarding its withdrawal. The assessed

contributions ensure assured funding, which WHO uses to pay the salaries of regular staff, both technical and administrative, and maintain day-to-day functioning. This is the minimum resources the organisation needs to ensure a continuity of operations. The other funding pool is from voluntary contributions (or VC) which comes from a range of donor agencies and additional contributions from WHO member-states. VCs are broadly for projects and other time-bound activities. WHO uses VC funds in the hiring of short-term staff and consultants. However, the problem with VC funds is that these are — as the name suggests — voluntary, always time-bound, linked to specific activities, and, thus, unpredictable. For example, many member-states and donors provide funds for polio elimination, patient safety, primary health care or antimicrobial resistance-related work. These contributions are tight-jacketed and non-transferable to other activities. With the U.S.'s withdrawal from WHO, the VC would also be impacted, as many U.S.-based or U.S.-aligned donors may either reduce, or worse, completely stop the funding to WHO. As an example, the ongoing turmoil and uncertain fate of USAID would additionally impact WHO funding. Clearly, the financial impact on WHO is likely to be far greater than the direct share of the U.S. government funds for WHO. Another argument given for the U.S.'s withdrawal, which has been used frequently by some others to criticise WHO, is that the organisation is highly bureaucratic, acts slow and is in need of urgent reforms. This is partially true and to be fair in assessment, every global institution needs some reforms and WHO is not any different. In fact, there is far more to WHO's credit than the occasional systemic blips it has faced. In this era of emerging and multi-sectoral challenges such as antimicrobial resistance, climate change, global warming and animal health, increasing re-emergence of diseases and a steep rise in lifestyle diseases, the world needs a stronger WHO, more than ever

Descriptive Writing (Precis writing: & Email Writing)

Original Text:

India is highly vulnerable to various natural and man-made disasters due to its geographical diversity and large population. Earthquakes, floods, cyclones, droughts, and industrial accidents frequently impact different regions, causing significant loss of life and property. Effective disaster management is crucial for minimizing damage and ensuring rapid recovery. The Government of India has taken several initiatives to strengthen disaster preparedness and response. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 established the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) to formulate policies, coordinate relief efforts, and enhance disaster resilience. Additionally, institutions like the Indian Meteorological Department (IMD) and National Remote Sensing Centre (NRSC) provide early warnings for cyclones, floods, and earthquakes, helping in timely evacuation andmitigation efforts. Disaster management in India follows a four-phase approach: Mitigation – Reducing disaster risks through infrastructure improvements, afforestation, and climate adaptation strategies. Preparedness – Conducting awareness campaigns, training programs, and mock drills for effective response. Response – Providing emergency aid, search and rescue operations, and medical assistance during disasters. Recovery – Rebuilding infrastructure, rehabilitating affected communities, and restoring livelihoods post-disaster. Despite these efforts, challenges remain, including inadequate infrastructure in rural areas, slow disaster relief distribution, and lack of public awareness. Strengthening early warning systems, investing in resilient infrastructure, and community participation can enhance India's disaster preparedness and response capabilities.

Precis

XPoSat is India’s first X-ray polarimetry mission by ISRO, designed to study cosmic X-ray sources like black holes and neutron stars. It carries two scientific payloads: POLIX, for measuring X-ray polarization, and XSPECT, for studying spectral and timing properties. Operating in low Earth orbit, XPoSat will enhance understanding of high-energy astrophysics over its five-year mission. The satellite marks India's entry into advanced X-ray astronomy, contributing valuable scientific data and strengthening its space research capabilities.

- **Write an email to an e-commerce company requesting a refund for a defective product you received. Mention the order ID and provide evidence, if required.**

To: ……@gmail.com

Subject: Request for Refund – Defective Product Received (Order ID: [Your Order ID])

Dear [Customer Support Team/Specific Contact Name],

I hope this email finds you well. I recently placed an order on your platform, but unfortunately, I received a defective product. Below are the details of my purchase: Order ID: [Your Order ID] Product Name: [Product Name] Date of Delivery: [Delivery Date] Upon unboxing, I noticed that [describe the defect—e.g., "the product is not functioning as expected," "there is visible damage," "it is different from the description on the website"]. I have attached relevant photos/videos as evidence of the issue. As per your refund policy,
I kindly request a full refund for this order. Please let me know if you need any additional information or if there are any further steps I should follow to process the refund. I would appreciate a prompt resolution to this matter. Looking forward to your response.
Best regards,
[Your Name]
[Your Contact Information]

Perfection Vocab

- **Emphasize** – To stress the importance of something.
- **External** – Coming from outside.
- **Uncertainty** – Lack of predictability or stability.
- **Reliance** – Dependence on something or someone.
- **Anxiety** – A feeling of nervousness or worry.
- **Self-reliance** – The ability to depend on oneself.
- **Atma** – A concept in Hinduism meaning the soul or self.
- **Ishvara** – A term referring to God or supreme being in Hinduism.
- **Divine** – Related to God or a higher power.
- **Confidence** – A belief in one's abilities.
- **Posture** – The way a person holds their body.
- **Flexibility** – The ability to bend without breaking.
- **Nervous system** – The network of nerves controlling the body.
- **Emotional stability** – The ability to remain calm under stress.
- **Self-development** – Improving oneself in various aspects of life.
- **Rampage** – A violent, uncontrolled action or movement.
- **Erupted** – Suddenly burst into activity.
- **Smashing** – Breaking something into pieces forcefully.
- **Overturning** – Flipping or turning something upside down.
- **Wild animal** – A creature that lives in nature, not domesticated.
- **Panic** – A sudden feeling of fear that leads to chaos.
- **Village** – A small settlement or community.
- **Storm** – Severe weather conditions with strong winds and rain.
- **Destruction** – Complete damage or ruin.
- **Debris** – Scattered remains of something broken.
- **Coastline** – The land along the edge of a sea or ocean.
- **Tornado** – A violent rotating column of air.

- **Riot** − A violent public disturbance.
- **Chaos** − Complete disorder and confusion.
- **Devastation** − Extreme damage or destruction.
- **Rankled** – Caused persistent annoyance or resentment.
- **Interruptions** – Disturbances that break the flow of an activity.
- **Speaker** – A person who is talking, especially in a formal setting.
- **Train of thought** – A sequence of connected ideas.
- **Harsh** – Unpleasantly rough or severe.
- **Feedback** – Comments or evaluations given to improve something.
- **Panel** – A group of experts gathered to discuss or evaluate something.
- **Motivation** – The reason or drive to act in a certain way.
- **Demands** – Firm requests or requirements.
- **Striking workers** – Employees who stop working to protest for better conditions.
- **Negotiate** – To discuss terms and reach an agreement.
- **Concede** – To give in or admit something.
- **Frustration** – A feeling of annoyance due to obstacles.
- **Resentment** – Bitterness or anger about something perceived as unfair.
- **Provoked** – Caused a reaction, often negative.
- **Precarious** – Unstable or uncertain.
- **Swayed** – Moved back and forth unsteadily.
- **Fragile** – Easily broken or damaged.
- **Unpredictable** – Difficult to foresee or control.
- **Delicate** – Easily affected or harmed.
- **Unstable** – Not steady or secure.
- **Critical** – Crucial or important.
- **Vulnerable** – Open to harm or attack.
- **Tenuous** – Weak or flimsy.

- **Perilous** – Full of danger.
- **Endangered** – At risk of harm.
- **Haphazard** – Lacking order or direction.
- **Insecure** – Lacking stability or safety.
- **Risky** – Full of uncertainty or danger.
- **Hazardous** – Potentially dangerous.
- **Prototype** – An early model or sample of a product used for testing and development.
- **Developed** – Created or improved over time through planning and effort.
- **Extensive** – Covering a large area or involving great detail and effort.
- **Trials** – Tests conducted to evaluate the performance or effectiveness of something.
- **Corridor** – A specific route or passageway, often used for transportation.
- **Quantify** – To measure or express something in numerical terms.
- **Benefit** – An advantage or positive outcome gained from something.
- **Economy** – The system of production, trade, and consumption of goods and services in a country or region.
- **High-speed rail** – A railway system designed for fast-moving trains that travel at high speeds.
- **Shinkansen** – The Japanese bullet train system known for its speed and efficiency.
- **Agriculture** – The practice of cultivating crops and raising livestock for food and other products.
- **Union Budget** – The annual financial statement presented by the government, outlining revenue and expenditure plans.
- **Climate Resilience** – The ability of a system, such as agriculture,

to withstand and adapt to climate-related challenges.

- **Agri-Processing** – The transformation of raw agricultural products into processed goods like packaged food or textiles.
- **Import Dependence** – A situation where a country relies heavily on foreign goods to meet its needs.
- **Pulses** – Edible seeds of leguminous plants, such as lentils, beans, and chickpeas.
- **Oilseeds** – Seeds used for extracting oil, such as mustard, sunflower, and soybean.
- **Augment** – To increase or improve something.
- **Incremental** – Gradual and step-by-step rather than sudden or dramatic.
- **Transformational** – Bringing major or significant change to a system or process.
- **Asteroid** – A small rocky body orbiting the sun, usually found in the asteroid belt between Mars and Jupiter.
- **Diameter** – The length of a straight line passing through the center of a circle or sphere.
- **Localized** – Restricted to a particular place or area.
- **Estimate** – To make an approximate judgment or calculation.
- **Strike** – To hit or impact something forcefully.
- **Potential** – Having the possibility of occurring or developing.
- **Blast damage** – Destruction caused by an explosion or impact.
- **Colliding** – Crashing into something forcefully.
- **Monitoring** – Observing and tracking something over time.
- **Risk** – The possibility of danger or harm.
- **Tend** – To be likely to behave in a certain way.
- **Significant** – Important or meaningful.
- **Pose** – To present or create (a risk, threat, or challenge).
- **Disrupt** – To cause disorder or break a normal process.

- **NASA** – The U.S. government agency responsible for space exploration.
- **Transition** – A process of change from one state or condition to another.
- **Independence** – The ability to manage oneself without relying on others.
- **Toughest** – Most difficult or challenging.
- **Test** – A challenge or assessment.
- **Academic** – Related to studies or education.
- **Pressure** – Stress or difficulty due to high expectations.
- **Responsibilities** – Duties or obligations.
- **Adjustments** – Changes made to adapt to a new situation.
- **Manage** – To handle or deal with something successfully.
- **Social** – Related to interactions with other people.
- **Struggle** – A difficult effort to achieve something.
- **Balance** – To maintain stability among different aspects of life.
- **Adulthood** – The state of being an adult.
- **Challenge** – A difficult task or obstacle.
- **Coping** – Dealing with problems or difficulties.

- **Library** − A place where books and other materials are kept for reading and research.
- **Little** − A small amount, meaning very few in number.
- **Subject** − A particular topic or area of study.
- **Available** − Ready to be used or obtained.
- **Recommended** − Suggested as good or suitable.
- **Highly** − To a great degree or extent.
- **Experts** − People with a high level of knowledge in a specific field.
- **Field** − An area of study or expertise.
- **Rare** − Not commonly found or occurring.

- **Resources** – Materials or sources of information.
- **Informative** – Providing useful knowledge or information.
- **Valuable** – Having great worth or importance.
- **Extensive** – Covering a large area or range.
- **Curated** – Carefully selected and organized.
- **Collection** – A group of items gathered together.
- **External** – Coming from outside.
- **Threats** – Potential dangers or risks.
- **Increased** – Became greater in size or intensity.
- **Defence** – Protection against attack or harm.
- **Capabilities** – The abilities or skills to do something.
- **Stagnated** – Stopped developing or progressing.
- **Declined** – Became weaker or reduced in strength.
- **Conflict** – A serious disagreement or struggle.
- **Strategic** – Related to careful planning for achieving goals.
- **Military** – Related to armed forces.
- **Border** – The dividing line between two regions or countries.
- **Security** – Protection from harm or danger.
- **Surveillance** – Close observation of a place or person.
- **Geopolitical** – Related to global politics and international relations.
- **Vulnerability** – The state of being open to attack or harm.
- **Competitive** – Involving competition or rivalry.
- **Market** – A place or system where goods and services are bought and sold.
- **Businesses** – Companies or enterprises engaged in commercial activities.
- **Loose** – Incorrect spelling; should be "lose" (to no longer have something).
- **Relevance** – Importance or connection to a topic.

- **Adapt** – To adjust to changes.
- **Changing** – Becoming different or evolving.
- **Consumer** – A person who buys goods and services.
- **Needs** – Requirements or necessities.
- **Preferences** – Choices or likings.
- **Innovation** – The introduction of new ideas or products.
- **Trend** – A general direction of change.
- **Demand** – The desire or need for a product or service.
- **Survival** – Continuing to exist despite challenges.
- **Profitability** – The ability to generate financial gain.
- **Recover** – To regain strength or energy.
- **Intense** – Strong or extreme in force or degree.
- **Schedule** – A planned timetable of events.
- **Back-to-back** – Consecutive or happening without a break.
- **Matches** – Competitive games or contests.
- **Performance** – The act of carrying out an activity.
- **Impacted** – Affected or influenced.
- **Fatigue** – Extreme tiredness.
- **Strain** – Physical or mental stress.
- **Endurance** – The ability to withstand stress over time.
- **Recovery** – The process of getting back to normal health.
- **Exhaustion** – Complete depletion of energy.
- **Dehydration** – Loss of water from the body.
- **Athlete** – A person trained in sports.
- **Conditioning** – Physical training to improve performance.
- **Saturation** − The state of being filled to capacity.
- **Skepticism** − Doubt or questioning attitude.
- **Suspicion** − A feeling that something is wrong.
- **Indispensable** − Absolutely necessary.
- **Inimical** − Harmful or hostile.

- **Imperative** – Extremely important or necessary.
- **Integral** – Essential or necessary for completeness.
- **Pivotal** – Very important or crucial.
- **Significance** – The importance of something.
- **Breaking the ice** – Making people feel more comfortable in a social situation.
- **Stabbing in the back** – Betraying someone.
- **Flying under the radar** – Avoiding attention.
- **Erect** – To build or establish.
- **Shatter** – To break into many pieces.
- **Delicate** – Easily broken or damaged.
- **Saturation** – The state of being completely filled or soaked; maximum capacity reached.
  Skepticism – A doubting or questioning attitude towards something.
  Suspicion – A feeling or belief that something is wrong or someone is guilty.
- **Indispensable** – Absolutely necessary; essential.
  Inimical – Harmful or hostile.
  Imperative – Extremely important or necessary.
- **Integral** – Essential or necessary for completeness.
  Pivotal – Very important; playing a central role.
  Significance – The importance or meaning of something.
- **Breaking the ice** – Making people feel more comfortable in a social situation, especially for the first time.
  Stabbing in the back – Betraying someone who trusts you.
  Flying under the radar – Avoiding attention or detection.
- **Erect** – To build, construct, or set up.
  Shatter – To break into many pieces; to destroy completely.
  Habilitate – To restore or enable someone or something to

function properly.

- **Implicative** – Suggesting or implying something indirectly.
  Fragile – Easily broken or damaged.
  Delicate – Fine, soft, or easily harmed.

Perfection(with annotation)pdf

Direction (1-5): Below are some statements, given in a random order. When these statements are sequenced properly, they'll form a coherent and meaningful paragraph.

30 Ques - 20 mins
[17 -18 min]
+1
-.25
0
Marks

ED - 5 Ques - 30sec - 2.5 min
Spelling PR/WO/WS/MC/S&C - 5 Ques - 30sec - 2.5 min
Fillers - 5Q 30 sec - 2.5 min
5 cloze Test - 30sec + 30sec/Q - 3.5 min
PJ - 2.5 min
RC - 5 - 7 min
(7 - 8) Ques

1 10

P. Space agencies reported that the asteroid named 2024 YR4, has a 1.2% chance of hitting our planet __*(A)*__ December 22, 2032.

Q. Asteroids of this smaller size tend to strike Earth once every few thousand years, with the potential to cause significant damage to localized regions.

SPRQT

R. They further estimate that the asteroid measures between 131 and 328 feet (40 and 100 meters) in diameter.

S. NASA and the European Space Agency are closely monitoring the recently discovered asteroid, which poses a small risk of colliding with Earth.

S [PRQ] T

PR
RQ
QT

T. But if the asteroid turns out to be on the large end of its estimated size range, the impact could produce blast damage as far as 50 kilometres (31 miles) from the impact site.

P. Space agencies reported that the asteroid named 2024 YR4, has a 1.2% chance of hitting our planet __*(A)*__ on December 22, 2032.

1 Day

(a) in

(b) on

(c) at

(d) for

(e) since

Question 1:

Which of the following is appropriate with the **blank (A)?**

F S this

S P R Q T

They But (damage)

Question 2:

Which of the following options is the pair of the **Antipenultimate** (3rd last) statement and the **Penultimate** (2nd last) statement, respectively, after the correct rearrangement?

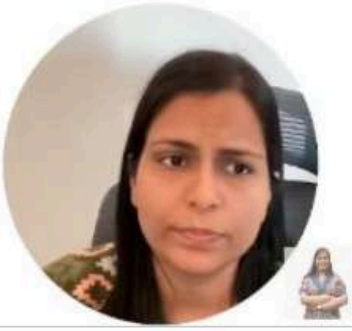
(a) ST

(b) PR

(c) RQ

(d) PS

(e) QT



Question 6:

For many students, the transition from school to college (A)/ becomes one of the toughest tests of their independence, (B)/ as they have to manage academic pressure, (C)/ personal responsibilities, and social adjustments all at once. (D)

One of the + Plural Noun +
Each of the
Everyone of the

(a) A
(b) B
(c) C
(d) D
(e) No error

Question 6:

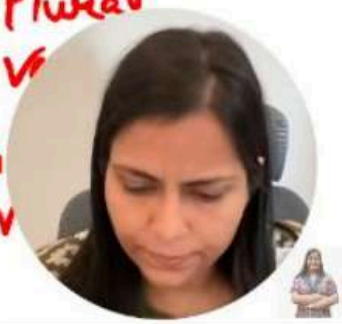
For many students, the transition from school to college (A)/ becomes one of the toughest test of their independence, (B)/ as they have to manage academic pressure, (C)/ personal responsibilities, and social adjustments all at once. (D)

(a) A
(b) B
(c) C
(d) D
(e) No error

One of the + Plural Noun + who/which/that + Plural V

+ X + Si V

Only one + Plural Noun + Sing Verb



Question 7:

The library had little books on (A)/ the subject, but the ones (B)/ available were highly recommended (C)/ by experts in the field. (D)

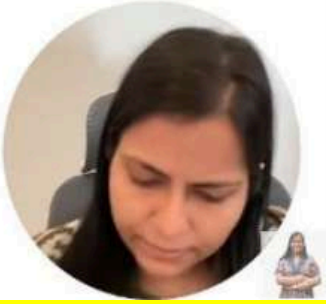
few

Adj. verb

(-ve) little – Uncountable Nouns
(+ve) a little
Neut. the little

(-ve) few – Countable Noun
(+ve) a few
N. the few

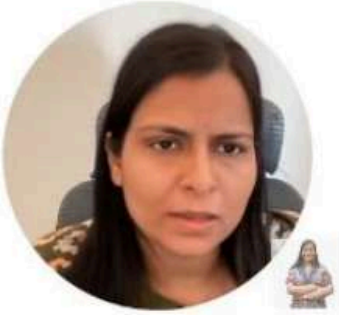
(a) A
(b) B
(c) C
(d) D
(e) No error



Question 8:

Over the past few years, India's external (A)/ security threats have increased, even (B)/ as our defence capabilities have (C)/ stagnated or, in some cases, declined. (D)

(a) A
(b) B
(c) C
(d) D
(e) No error



Question 9:

In a competitive market, businesses (A)/ can loose their relevance if (B)/ they do not adapt to changing (C)/ consumer needs and preferences. (D)

(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

(d) D

(e) No error

Question 10:

The team is yet to recover from (A)/ the intense schedule of back-to-back (B)/ matches, and their performance (C)/ has impacted by fatigue. (D)

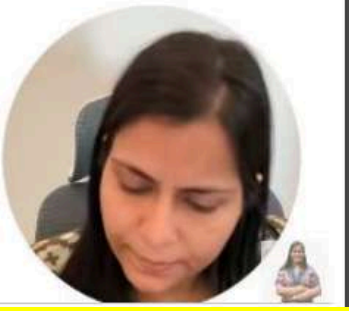
(a) A

(b) B

(c) C

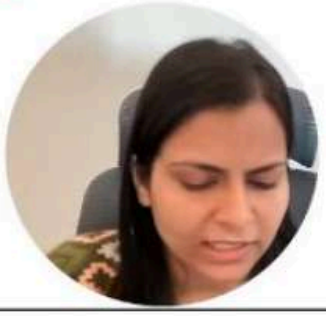
(d) D

(e) No error



The debate surrounding AI is intensifying, and so is the __(A)__ . But AI is here to stay. While some headlines criticise tech giants for AI-driven social media or questionable consumer tools, AI itself is becoming __(B)__ . Its efficiency is unmatched, promising gains that no business or government can ignore. In India, forecasts indicate that generative AI could add between $359 billion and $438 billion to the GDP by 2029-30 as recently cited by Michael Debabrata Patra, Deputy Governor of Reserve Bank of India. This means, very soon, AI will be as __(C)_ to our lives as electricity – powering our cars, shaping our healthcare, securing our banks, and keeping the lights on. The big question is, are we ready for what comes next? The public conversation around AI has largely focused on ethics, misinformation, and the future of work. But one vital issue is _(D)_ : the security of AI itself. With AI embedded in nearly every part of society, we're creating massive, interconnected systems with the power to shape – or, in the wrong hands,__(E)__– our daily lives. Are we prepared for the_____ risks? As we give AI more control over tasks – from diagnosing diseases to managing physical access to sensitive locations – the fallout from a cyberattack grows exponentially. Disturbingly, some AIs are as __(F)__ as they are powerful.

AI



The debate surrounding AI is intensifying, and so is the __(A)__ . But AI is here to stay.

Noun

-ve

Contrast

+ve

Question 11:

Which of the following appropriately fits in **Option A?**

I. saturation

II. skepticism

III. suspicion

] (-ve) state of Doubt

Noun

→ P of S

→ Tone

→ Vocabulary

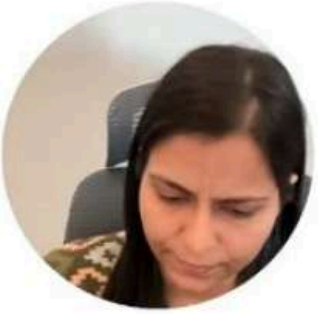
(a) Only I

(b) Both II and III

(c) Both I and III

(d) Both I and II

(e) All I, II and III



Contrast (-ve)

While some headlines criticise tech giants for AI-driven social media or questionable consumer tools, AI itself is becoming __(B)__ (+ve) Adj. Its efficiency is unmatched, promising gains that no business or government can ignore.

Question 12:

Which of the following appropriately fits in **Option B?**

I. indispensable - important (+ve)

II. Inimical - dangerous (-ve)

III. imperative important (+ve)

Adj

(a) Only II

(b) Both II and III

(c) Both I and III

(d) Both I and II

(e) All I, II and III

c

This means, very soon, AI will be as __(C)__ Adj (+ve) to our lives as electricity – powering our cars, shaping our healthcare, securing our banks, and keeping the lights on.

Question 13:

Which of the following appropriately fits in **Option C?**

Adj

I. integral - important (+ve)

II. pivotal - important (+ve)

III. significance - importance

Noun

(a) Only I

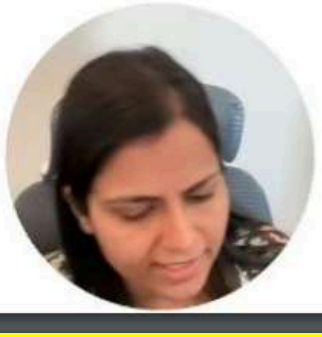
(b) Both II and III

(c) Both I and III

(d) Both I and II

(e) All I, II and III

d



But one vital issue is _(D)_ : the security of AI itself. With AI embedded in nearly every part of society, we're creating massive, interconnected systems with the power to shape – or, in the wrong hands,__(E)__– our daily lives. Are we prepared for the

Question 14:

Which of the following appropriately fits in **Option D?**

I. breaking the ice

II. Stabbing in the back

III. flying under the radar

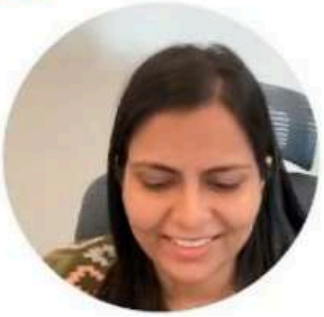
(a) Only III

(b) Both II and III

(c) Both I and III

(d) Both I and II

(e) All I, II and III



With AI embedded in nearly every part of society, we're creating massive, interconnected systems with the power to shape – or, in the wrong hands,__(E)__– our daily lives. Are we prepared for the risks?

Question 15:

Which of the following appropriately fits in **Option E?**

I. erect

II. shatter

III. habilitate

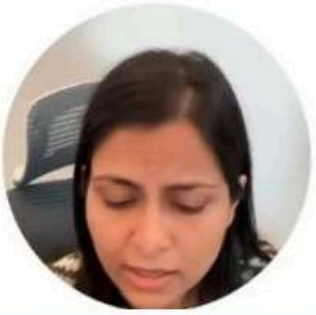
(a) Only III

(b) Only II

(c) Both I and II

(d) Only I

(e) All I, II and III



As we give AI more control over tasks – from diagnosing diseases to managing physical access to sensitive locations – the fallout from a cyberattack grows exponentially. Disturbingly, some AIs are as __(F)_as they are powerful.

Adj (-ve)

Question 16:

Which of the following appropriately fits in **Option F?**

something that implies

I. implicative

II. fragile
III. delicate

} Adj - weak

(a) Only I

(b) Both I and III

(c) Both I and II

(d) Both II and III

(e) All I, II and III

d

Column 1	Column 2
(A) The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) new governor, Sanjay Malhotra,	(D) and assess the interlinkages between monetary policy, fiscal policy, and the banking system.
(B) The committee's objective was to review the functioning of the monetary system, keeping the planning era in mind,	(E) between inflation and unemployment but not a permanent one.
(C) In 1968, Milton Friedman argued that there could be a temporary trade-off	(F) is going to chair his first Monetary Policy Committee meeting on February 5-7.

Question 17:

(a) ~~A-E, B-D and C-F~~

(b) ~~A-E, B-F and C-D~~

(c) A-F, B-D and C-E

(d) A-F, B-E and C-D

(e) None of the above

c

Column 1	Column 2
(A) The big question for agriculture in the Union Budget for FY26 is whether it can bring climate resilience	(D) for agri-processing industries like cotton and maize, leading to rising import dependence.
(B) India continues to face shortages in pulses, oilseeds, and key raw materials	(E) and augment the productivity and incomes of farmers and farm labourers.
(C) While the FY26 Budget makes some progress in addressing agricultural challenges,	(F) the overall approach remains incremental rather than transformational.

Noun

Conto (+ve) (-ve)

Question 18:

(a) A-E, B-F and C-D

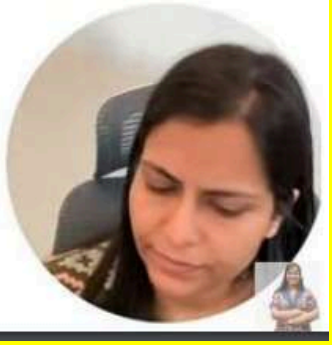
(b) A-D, B-F and C-E

(c) A-D, B-E and C-F

(d) A-E, B-D and C-F

(e) None of the above

d



Column 1	Column 2
(A) The first prototype will be developed in the next two years and will	(D) there are suggestions that cities connected by high-speed rail economically benefit more than those who are not.
(B) The increase in the speed of Vande Bharats to 280 kmph is based on Japanese experience	(E) undergo extensive trials on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad high-speed corridor.
(C) It is difficult to quantify the benefit of bullet trains on the economy although	(F) as the first Shinkansen in 1964 ran up 210 kmph which later reached 320 kmph.

Question 19:

(a) A-F, B-D and C-E

(b) A-E, B-F and C-D

(c) A-D, B-E and C-F

(d) A-E, B-D and C-F

(e) None of the above

B

Column 1	Column 2
(A) The Chinese model, which comes as an alternative to OpenAI's ChatGPT and Google's Gemini,	(D) opens the whole debate around the geopolitical implications of AI.
(B) The launch of the $500 billion Stargate project in the US and the latest export control order on graphics processing units (GPUs)	(E) compared to ChatGPT which goes through all the knowledge and puts all the capabilities at one go.
(C) Experts said DeepSeek follows a balanced loading approach when dealing with prompt	(F) unlike its US counterparts fully relies on open-source technology and lower-end chips.

Question 20:

(a) ~~A-E, B-D and C-F~~

(b) ~~A-E, B-F and C-D~~

(c) A-F, B-D and C-E

(d) A-F, B-E and C-D

(e) None of the above

Column 1	Column 2
(A) The long-awaited rules, published following much discussion and inter-ministry consultation,	(D) will be open for public comments for at least 45 days.
(B) The release of the draft rules marks an important step towards recognising,	(E) manufacturing a traditional internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicle.
(C) Producing an EV is significantly more energy-intensive than	(F) enforcing, and strengthening data protection norms in India.

Question 21:

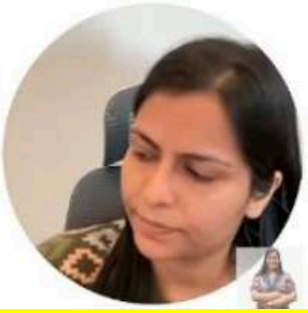
(a) ~~A-E, B-F and C-D~~

(b) A-D, B-F and C-E

(c) A-D, B-E and C-F

(d) ~~A-E, B-D and C-F~~

(e) None of the above



Question 22:

Precarious - Adj → unstable not secure

I. The hikers carefully crossed the **precarious** bridge that swayed with every step.

II. In the desert, every drop of water is **precarious** and must be conserved.

precious weak

III. The fragile peace between the rival groups remained **precarious** and could break at any time.

unstable

(a) Both I and II

(b) Only II

(c) Only I

(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

Question 23:

Rankled - nettle irk chafe pester vex perturb exasperate annoy ruffle

I. The constant interruptions during the meeting **rankled** the speaker, causing him to lose his train of thought.

irritate peave rile gall

II. The harsh feedback from the panel **rankled** the young artist, but she took it as motivation to improve her skills.

agreed acceded

III. The government finally **rankled** to the demands of the striking workers, agreeing to negotiate their wages.

(a) Both I and II

(b) Only II

(c) Both II and III

(d) Only III

(e) All I, II and III

Question 24:

N

Rampage – Violence Destruction

I. After receiving the news of the defeat, the fans erupted into a **rampage**, smashing windows and overturning cars.

II. The wild animal went on a **rampage** through the village, causing panic among the residents.

III. The storm caused a **rampage** of destruction along the coastline, leaving behind debris and damaged homes.

(a) Only I

(b) Both I and II

(c) Only III

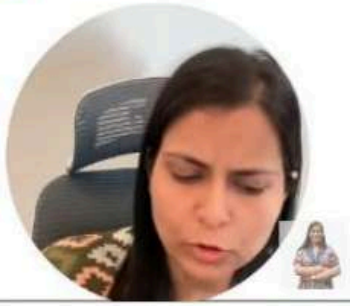
(d) Both I and III

(e) All I, II and III

e

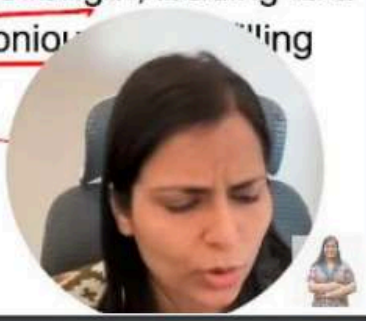
Yoga Shastras emphasize that true happiness comes from within rather than external sources. Depending on others for happiness leads to uncertainty, as external conditions are unpredictable. This reliance can cause anxiety, making self-reliance a crucial principle in yoga. The concept of "self" in yoga is closely connected to God, where Atma (self) and Ishvara (God) are considered inseparable. Recognizing this connection encourages individuals to rely on divine strength rather than external circumstances. Instead of seeking _____ from others, one should focus on their own actions and thoughts. Self-reliance involves three key aspects: performing duties correctly, developing confidence, and maintaining a stable mindset. A confident person **exhibits** upright posture, remains unaffected by external judgments, and faces challenges with inner calm. This inner strength fosters a peaceful state of mind. Yoga places great emphasis on spinal flexibility, linking it directly to confidence and well-being.

45sec



Unlike modern fitness trends that prioritize muscle strength through jogging, swimming, and weight training, yoga focuses on the nervous system. The spine, being the core of the nervous system, influences mental clarity, emotional stability, and overall health. A flexible spine leads to a flexible mind, reducing stress and promoting inner peace.Furthermore, yoga discourages emotional dependence on others. Many people allow external situations or opinions to dictate their happiness. However, true self-confidence arises when one is unaffected by external praise or criticism. **Cultivating** this independence ensures lasting inner peace.A comprehensive approach to self-development is essential—physically through spinal flexibility, mentally through positive thinking, and emotionally through faith in God.

By working on oneself holistically, confidence and willpower naturally grow. Yoga teaches that happiness is a personal choice and should not be influenced by others. True self-confidence emerges when individuals develop inner strength, leading to a harmoniou[illegible]ling life.



Q25. **According to the passage, why does yoga emphasize self-reliance over dependence on external factors?**

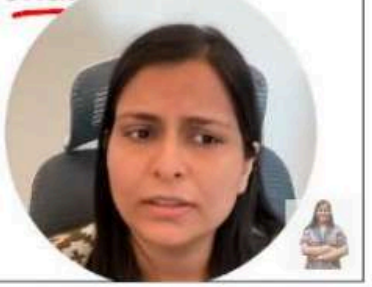
(a) Because external circumstances can sometimes be favorable and bring happiness but are mostly unpredictable.

(b) Since emotional dependence on others reduces personal control, self-reliance ensures consistent happiness.

(c) Because external factors such as relationships and wealth contribute only partially to a person's inner peace.

(d) Since yoga believes that happiness should be equally derived from both internal and external sources.

(e) Because self-reliance in yoga refers only to performing one's duties properly, not to emotional st[illegible]



Q26. What is the significance of the spine according to yoga philosophy?

(a) The spine is a core component of physical fitness, and its flexibility ensures a strong muscular system.
(b) Yoga prioritizes spinal flexibility because it ensures smooth blood circulation and a healthy respiratory system.
(c) A flexible spine indicates strong nerves, which are essential for maintaining mental and emotional balance.
(d) The spinal cord represents an individual's physical endurance and ability to perform complex physical activities.
(e) A strong spine is only essential for maintaining good posture and preventing back pain.

Q27. Which of the following best describes the connection between self and God as per the passage?

(a) Self-awareness and spiritual enlightenment are independent of any divine connection in yoga.
(b) The Atma (self) is separate from Ishvara (God) but should still seek guidance from divine teachings.
(c) The self and God are deeply connected, and understanding this relationship helps in self-reliance.
(d) God influences external situations, so dependence on external factors is ultimately dependence on God.
(e) Yoga encourages seeking validation from God rather than from other people for happiness.

Instead of seeking _____ from others, one should focus on their own actions and thoughts.

Q28.Choose the correct word to fill in the blank:

(a) association

(b) assistance

(c) spirituality

(d) connection

(e) validation

A confident person **exhibits** upright posture, remains unaffected by external judgments, and faces challenges with inner calm.

Q29.What is a synonym for "**exhibits**" as used in the passage?

Synonym

→ exhibit

Success

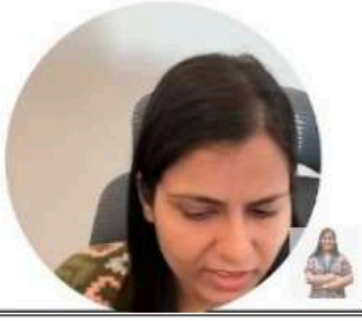
(a) suppresses

(b) replicates

(c) challenges

(d) demonstrates

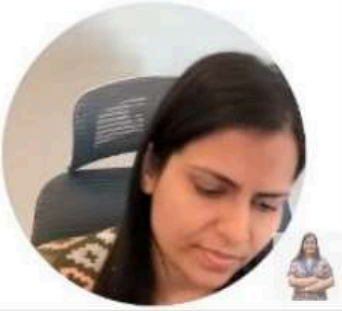
(e) imitates



However, true self-confidence arises when one is unaffected by external praise or criticism. **Cultivating** this independence ensures lasting inner peace.

Q30.What is the antonym of "cultivating" as per the passage's context?

(a) nurturing
(b) neglecting
(c) enhancing
(d) questioning
(e) resembling



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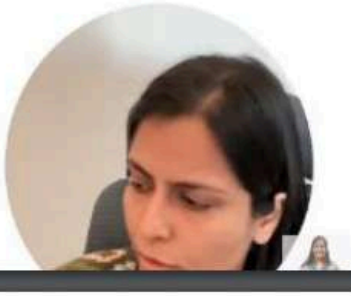

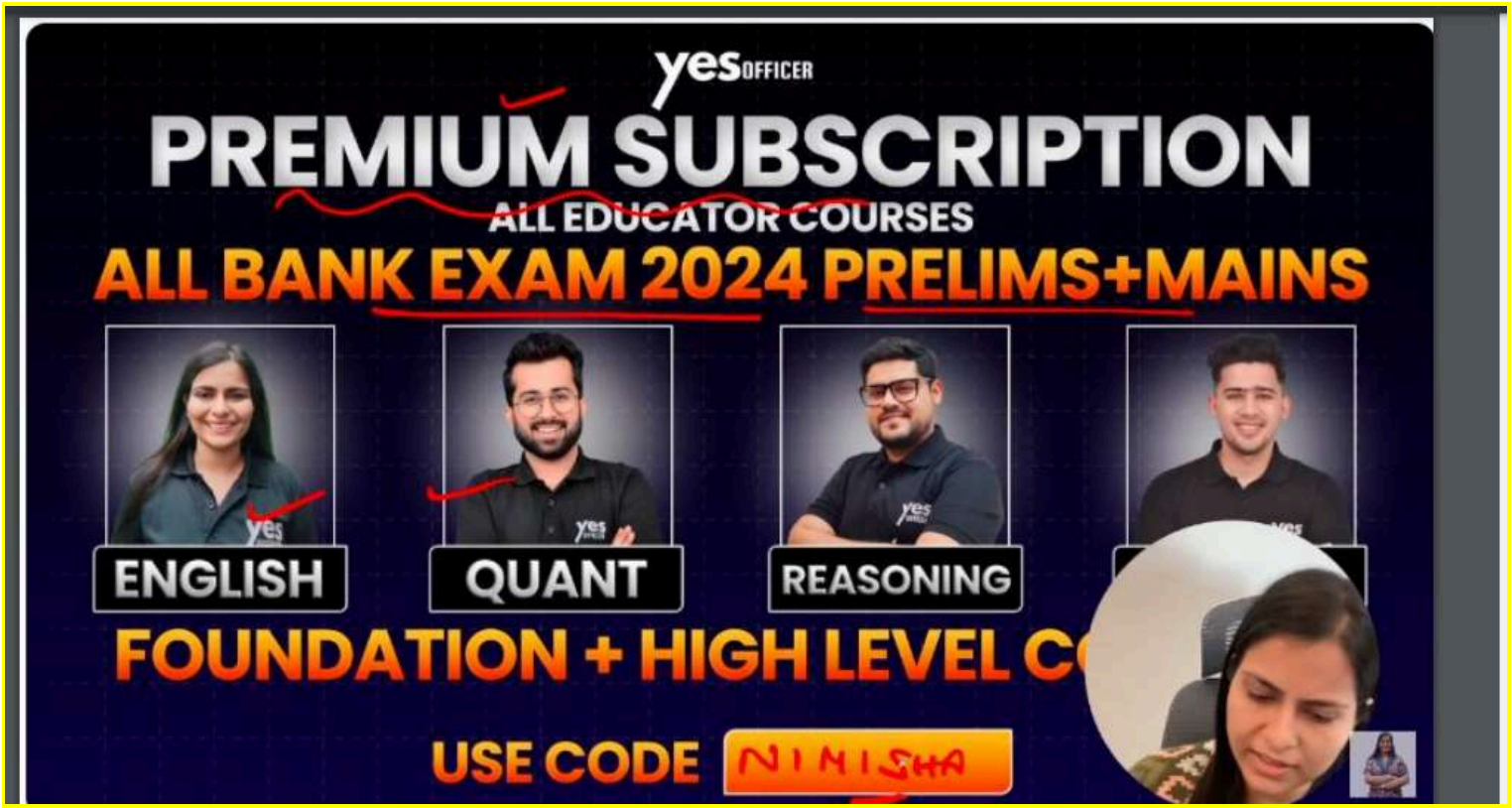
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